

D632

Cultural Competency and Social-Emotional Learning

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

During a group project in a school with a new media center, a sixth grader notices a classmate looks upset after being interrupted and asks how she is feeling. The student plays on the school soccer team. Which SEL competency is this student showing?

- A. Self-awareness.
- B. Social awareness.
- C. Self-management.
- D. Teamwork from soccer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student feels angry after losing a game, takes three deep breaths, and waits before responding. Which competency is this?

- A. Social awareness.
- B. Relationship skills.
- C. Responsible decision-making, because every calm choice is a decision.
- D. Self-management.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A school gives every student the same take-home laptop for homework. The school recently won a regional robotics award. A survey shows 22% of students have no home internet. What is the most equitable next step?

- A. Provide hotspots or offline options to the students without internet.
- B. Keep the plan as is, since every student got the same laptop.
- C. Take back all laptops so no one has an advantage.
- D. Ask the robotics team to fix the problem.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which policy is an example of equality rather than equity?

- A.** Students without transportation get bus passes for tutoring.
- B.** Students reading below grade level get extra small-group time.
- C.** Every student gets exactly 30 minutes of tutoring a week, whatever their need.
- D.** Multilingual learners get translated materials.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A principal in a district with a new strategic plan says the school is culturally responsive because it holds an international food night each spring. Attendance last year was 400 people. Which change would move the school toward culturally responsive pedagogy?

- A.** Build daily lessons that connect content to students' cultures while keeping rigorous expectations.
- B.** Hold two food nights instead of one.
- C.** Lower grading standards for students from diverse backgrounds.
- D.** Aim for 800 attendees next year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In a team meeting in the school's newly renovated library, a teacher says newcomer students "come in with nothing" because they speak little English. Several of these students speak two other languages fluently. What reframing best reflects an asset-based view?

- A.** These students need to stop using their home languages at school.
- B.** These students should wait to learn content until English is fluent.
- C.** These students bring multilingual skills we can use as a bridge to English and content learning.
- D.** Every newcomer will struggle no matter what.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A veteran teacher at a school with a strong music program says, “I don’t see culture in my classroom; I treat every student exactly the same.” She has taught for 22 years. Where does this fall on the cultural proficiency continuum?

- A. Cultural competence, given her long experience.
- B. Cultural proficiency.
- C. Cultural destructiveness.
- D. Cultural blindness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher recognizes she has gaps in understanding her students’ cultures and begins attending community events and adjusting lessons. Where is she on the continuum?

- A. Cultural pre-competence.
- B. Cultural incapacity.
- C. Cultural proficiency, because she is taking action.
- D. Cultural blindness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A middle school launches SEL with a kickoff assembly and hallway posters about kindness. The school has 700 students and recently repaved its parking lot. Which addition would most make this an effective SEL program?

- A. Wait until all 700 students show a need.
- B. Regular explicit lessons that teach and practice specific skills, reinforced by teachers across classes.
- C. More posters in every classroom.
- D. A second assembly at midyear.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A high school's advanced course enrollment is 30% of 1,000 students. Of 600 students from one group, 240 enroll; of 400 students from another group, 60 enroll. The school has a well-known debate team. What does disaggregation reveal?

- A. Enrollment reflects debate team membership.
- B. The second group enrolls at 60%.
- C. Both groups enroll at about 30%.
- D. A 40% vs. 15% gap between the groups, hidden by the 30% overall rate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A group of 200 students has an 18% chronic absence rate. How many students in this group are chronically absent?

- A. 11
- B. 18
- C. 36
- D. 164

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A school leader wants the district to change a policy that places many multilingual learners in lower-level classes. She has worked in the district for nine years and has a large office. Which approach reflects effective advocacy?

- A. Decide on a new policy for families without asking them.
- B. Present placement data and bring affected families and students into planning and presentations to the board.
- C. Write a memo alone based on her personal opinion.
- D. Rely on her nine years of seniority to push it through.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

During a group project ~~in a school with a new media center~~, a sixth grader notices a classmate looks upset after being interrupted and asks how she is feeling. ~~The student plays on the school soccer team.~~ Which SEL competency is this student showing?

Target word: classify the competency **Decides:** Noticing and responding to another's feelings.

A	Adjacent category	Self-awareness is recognizing one's own emotions.
B	Correct	Reading and empathizing with another's emotions.
C	Confusion set	Self-management is regulating one's own emotions.
D	Camouflage	Not a named competency and not the deciding fact.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A student feels angry after losing a game, takes three deep breaths, and waits before responding. Which competency is this?

Target word: classify the competency **Decides:** Regulating one's own emotion.

A	Inverted operation	That focuses on others' feelings.
B	Adjacent category	Relationship skills are about interacting with others.
C	Absolute language	Stretches the category; the core act is emotional regulation.
D	Correct	Controlling one's own emotions and impulses.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A school gives every student the same take-home laptop for homework. ~~The school recently won a regional robotics award.~~ A survey shows 22% of students have no home internet. What is the most equitable next step?

Target word: equity response **Decides:** Some students cannot use the uniform resource.

A	Correct	Equity meets specific needs so all can reach the goal.
B	Confusion set	Equal resources are not equitable when needs differ.
C	Inverted operation	Removes access instead of closing the gap.
D	Camouflage	The award is irrelevant.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

Which policy is an example of equality rather than equity?

Target word: reverse: pick the equality example **Decides:** Same for everyone regardless of need.

A	Adjacent category	Removes a barrier based on need.
B	Inverted operation	Need-based support is equity.
C	Correct	Identical treatment regardless of need is equality.
D	Confusion set	Tailored support is equity.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A principal in a district with a new strategic plan says the school is culturally responsive because it holds an international food night each spring. Attendance last year was 400 people. Which change would move the school toward culturally responsive pedagogy?

Target word: what CRP really requires **Decides:** An event alone is not pedagogy.

A	Correct	CRP lives in instruction and high expectations.
B	Dropped element	Still an event, not pedagogy.
C	Inverted operation	CRP requires high expectations.
D	Camouflage	Attendance is not the measure.

6. Answer C Concept 4

In a team meeting in the school's newly renovated library, a teacher says newcomer students "come in with nothing" because they speak little English. Several of these students speak two other languages fluently. What reframing best reflects an asset-based view?

Target word: asset-based reframe **Decides:** Students' existing languages are strengths.

A	Inverted operation	Deficit approach that removes a resource.
B	Adjacent category	Delays learning; content and language can develop together.
C	Correct	Treats home languages as strengths to build on.
D	Absolute language	A sweeping deficit assumption.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A veteran teacher at a school with a strong music program says, "I don't see culture in my classroom; I treat every student exactly the same." She has taught for 22 years. Where does this fall on the cultural proficiency continuum?

Target word: place on the continuum **Decides:** Ignoring cultural differences.

A	Camouflage	Years of experience do not set the stage.
B	Inverted operation	Proficiency values and responds to differences.
C	Adjacent category	Destructiveness actively tries to eliminate cultures.
D	Correct	Refusing to see differences ignores their role in learning.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher recognizes she has gaps in understanding her students' cultures and begins attending community events and adjusting lessons. Where is she on the continuum?

Target word: classify the stage **Decides:** Awareness of limits and early efforts to respond.

A	Correct	Recognizes limits and starts taking action.
B	Adjacent category	Incapacity treats other cultures as inferior.
C	Confusion set	Proficiency is the highest stage of advocacy and ongoing learning; she is starting.
D	Inverted operation	Blindness ignores differences.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A middle school launches SEL with a kickoff assembly and hallway posters about kindness. The school has 700 students and ~~recently repaved its parking lot~~. Which addition would most make this an effective SEL program?

Target word: effective SEL features **Decides:** No explicit, sequenced skill instruction.

A	Wrong stem number	SEL is universal, not triggered by a count.
B	Correct	Sequenced, active, focused, explicit instruction.
C	Dropped element	Still no instruction or practice.
D	Adjacent category	Events do not replace explicit teaching.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A high school's advanced course enrollment is 30% of 1,000 students. Of 600 students from one group, 240 enroll; of 400 students from another group, 60 enroll. ~~The school has a well-known debate team~~. What does disaggregation reveal?

Target word: compare group rates **Decides:** $240/600 = 40\%$; $60/400 = 15\%$.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail.
B	Wrong stem number	60 is a count, not a rate.
C	Dropped element	Uses only the overall rate.
D	Correct	$240/600 = 40\%$; $60/400 = 15\%$; $(240+60)/1,000 = 30\%$.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A group of 200 students has an 18% chronic absence rate. How many students in this group are chronically absent?

Target word: solve for a count **Decides:** Count = rate $\times$ group size.

A	Confusion set	Divides 200 by 18 instead of multiplying by 18%.
B	Wrong stem number	Reads the rate as a count.
C	Correct	$0.18 \times 200 = 36$.
D	Inverted operation	That is the number not chronically absent.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A school leader wants the district to change a policy that places many multilingual learners in lower-level classes. ~~She has worked in the district for nine years and has a large office~~. Which approach reflects effective advocacy?

Target word: effective advocacy approach **Decides:** Uses data and involves affected families.

A	Inverted operation	Acts for, not with, the community.
B	Correct	Evidence plus coalition with those affected.
C	Dropped element	Lacks both evidence and coalition.
D	Camouflage	Seniority is not an advocacy strategy.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The five core SEL competencies	Self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, relationship skills, and responsible decision-making are distinct competencies.	Mixing up self-management (regulating oneself) and social awareness (understanding others).	A student behavior to classify.
2	Equity vs. equality	Equality gives everyone the same; equity gives each learner what they need to reach the same goals.	Assuming identical treatment is always fair.	A uniform resource that some students cannot use.
3	Culturally responsive pedagogy	Culturally responsive teaching holds high academic expectations, builds on students' cultures, and develops critical thinking about the world.	Reducing it to occasional cultural celebrations or lowering expectations.	A heritage month activity offered as the whole plan.
4	Asset-based vs. deficit thinking	Asset-based thinking treats students' languages, cultures, and experiences as strengths to build on.	Framing differences as problems to be fixed.	Talk about what students lack.
5	The cultural proficiency continuum	Responses range from destructiveness, incapacity, and blindness to pre-competence, competence, and proficiency; ignoring differences is cultural blindness.	Thinking "I don't see color" is the ideal.	A claim to treat everyone the same regardless of culture.
6	Effective SEL programs	Effective SEL is sequenced, active, focused, and explicit, and is reinforced across the school day.	Treating a one-time assembly or poster as SEL instruction.	An SEL plan with no explicit lessons or practice.
7	Disaggregating data	Break results out by student group to reveal inequities that school-wide averages hide.	Relying on an overall rate that looks fine.	An overall rate with group counts available.
8	Advocacy through coalition and evidence	Effective advocacy uses data and brings affected families and students into the effort to change policy.	Acting alone on opinion or deciding for communities without them.	A leader planning a change that affects a community.

Course scope (public description): Cultural Competency and Social-Emotional Learning focuses on empowering educational leaders with the knowledge and skills necessary to foster cultural competency, deepen their understanding of diverse learner populations, and apply culturally responsive pedagogy. This course places a strong emphasis on promoting social justice, equity, and inclusivity within educational contexts. Students in this course will engage in immersive learning experiences aimed at equipping them with the capacity to lead social-emotional learning initiatives that cater to the social and emotional needs of all learners. The course also empowers students with advocacy strategies to influence positive change in local and global educational environments, ensuring that educational leaders are well prepared to navigate the challenges and opportunities of today's diverse educational landscape. This course is designed to be taken after successful completion of D019: Data Literacy and Evidence-Based Practices.